

Sustainable Living Tips — General Guide

Energy at Home

- Switch to LED bulbs; they use up to 80% less energy than incandescent bulbs and last far longer.
- Unplug chargers and appliances when not in use — many devices draw “phantom load” power even when switched off.
- Set air conditioners to 24-26°C instead of 18-20°C; every degree lower can increase energy consumption by roughly 6%.
- Use natural light and ventilation during the day instead of running lights and fans continuously.
- Consider a smart power strip to cut power to idle electronics automatically.

Water Conservation

- Fix leaking taps immediately — a slow drip can waste over 15 liters of water a day.
- Install low-flow showerheads and faucet aerators to cut water use without reducing pressure.
- Collect and reuse RO reject water for cleaning, mopping, or watering plants.
- Water gardens early morning or late evening to reduce evaporation loss.
- Consider rainwater harvesting for terrace or balcony gardens if your building permits it.

Waste Reduction

- Practice the 5 Rs in order of priority: Refuse, Reduce, Reuse, Recycle, Rot (compost).
- Segregate waste at source into wet (biodegradable), dry (recyclable), and hazardous/reject categories — most Indian municipalities require this by law.
- Start home composting for kitchen scraps using a simple compost bin or pit; this diverts a large share of household waste from landfills.
- Buy in bulk or from refill stores to cut down on single-use packaging.
- Donate or repair items instead of discarding them when possible.

Food & Diet

- Reducing meat and dairy consumption, even partially, lowers an individual’s carbon footprint significantly, since livestock farming is resource- and emission-intensive.
- Buy local and seasonal produce to cut down on transportation emissions and cold storage energy use.
- Plan meals to reduce food waste — food waste in landfills produces methane, a potent greenhouse gas.
- Grow herbs or vegetables at home in balcony pots if space allows.

Daily Micro-Habits

- Carry a reusable water bottle, cloth bag, and steel/bamboo cutlery to avoid single-use plastic.

- Say no to plastic straws and cutlery when ordering food or drinks.
- Choose digital receipts and bills over printed ones where offered.
- Walk, cycle, or use public transport for short distances instead of a private vehicle.